

CURRENT AFFAIRS



**NEW REGIME
IN
SOUTH KOREA**

MINI CAPSULE

11-05-2017

8/19th Week



RUSSIA

MONGOLIA

KOREAN PENINSULA

Korea bay

Sea of Japan

North Pacific Ocean

Yellow Sea

CHINA

JAPAN

East China Sea

MONGOLIA

Learning Space

North
Korea

Sea of Japan

North Pacific Ocean

South Korea

CHINA

Learning Space

JAPAN

East China Sea





BRIEF HISTORY

- 1 Former president Park Geun-hye was impeached.
- 2 Choi Soon-sil was at the centre of controversy.
- 3 Now, elections were held, Moon Jae-in was elected as South Korea's President with 41% of the mandate, almost double that of his nearest rival.



NEWS ITEM

Park Geun-hye was impeached by the South Korean Parliament.



Park Geun-hye,
President, South Korea

- National Assembly voted to impeach her.
- She is South Korea's first women President as well as the first democratically elected South Korean leader to be forced out of office.
- She is accused of abusing power to help Choi Soon-sil, to extort funds from companies.
- Choi had allegedly influenced President Park on critical decisions.
- Hwang Kyo-ahn became the acting President subsequently.



PARK GEUN-HYE,
Impeached President, South Korea



CHOI SOON-SIL



HIS INITIAL REACTION



- 1 He declared his intention to visit Pyongyang and hold discussions with Washington, Beijing and Tokyo.
- 2 He was previously human rights lawyer and now his positive note for the kind of multilateralism assumed significance, which is required to lower tensions in the Korean peninsula.
- 3 It also allayed the apprehensions as people assumed that Mr. Moon may be rather soft towards the North Korea.



CHALLENGES



1

THAAD

- Now, the U.S is installing the Terminal High Altitude Area Defence (THAAD) anti-missile system on South Korean soil.
- The purpose is to intercept the North Korea's increasingly sophisticated missile launches.
- China raised apprehensions about this.
- China feels that the THAAD radar could undermine its own defence infrastructure.
- China would like nothing less than the complete withdrawal of the defence shield.





CHALLENGES

2 RELATIONS WITH NEIGHBOURS



1 Mr. Moon is normally known for accommodative stance and how he deals with North Korea is very important for the region as a whole.

2 Peaceful coexistence of the neighbours may prevail Mr. Moon's strategy over other factors.

3 In this context, rapid restoration of cultural, tourism and trade relations between Seoul and Beijing appears possible.



CHALLENGES

3 SETTING THE HOUSE IN ORDER



- 1 South Korea has been rocked in recent months by the influence-peddling scandal involving Ms. Park and executives from top business houses, leading to her exit.
- 2 The need of the hour is to live up to the expectations of the people who demonstrated on the streets for transparent and accountable corporate governance culture.
- 3 South Korea is known for a conventional chaebol system of family-owned businesses.



He can depend on vibrant and independent judiciary and an effective parliament to ensure transparency and accountability.

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